



BY SANDIP PATEL

Making India the 'Vishwa Tech Guru'

For India to leapfrog into the future, becoming a global No. 1 in technology is imperative



WE STAND AT the cusp of creating a new world for ourselves, enabled by technology that is changing the way we live, work and interact with our surroundings. The advent of technologies like cloud and artificial intelligence (AI) have challenged foundational beliefs that have prevailed for several decades and vastly expanded the realm of possibilities in a short span of time. In this evolutionary

journey, India has established itself as the global laboratory for creating tech-powered solutions to some of the most pressing challenges that impact our lives and livelihood. We have undergone a period of immense technological improvement in the last quarter of a century, and India today stands tall as one of the largest digital hubs in the world. We have firmly entered our nation's golden era—and this is truly proving to be India's techade.

When I envision India@100, I see India as one of the top economies, home to thriving communities, entrepreneurs and a global anchor for sustainable growth. I see India as a 'Vishwa Tech Guru' (the world's tech expert),

championing innovation in India, for India and the world. The next 25 years will usher in a *Suvarna Bharat* (Golden India) with technology being the *sutradhar* (a unifying force). The road to 100 for India is a growth highway that is laid on a strong underlying foundation of highly skilled and favourable demographics, technology prowess and entrepreneurial and innovative culture.

Realising this vision will require drastically new ways of thinking, the convergence of technologies like hybrid cloud, AI and quantum, and a much deeper collaboration between government, industry and academia to build a future-ready workforce. The challenge, using a cricket analogy, is we are off to a great start but how we consistently hit the boundaries and run between the wickets will determine whether we lift the trophy. I have no doubt we are great players of slog overs but we will need enough momentum right from the start to win. In my view, we need a 'Power 10' formula to get us to the finish line—to be a world leader in technology innovation and future-ready talent.

Exponential policy framework:

What will propel India forward with speed and scale is an unmatched focus on policy reforms that keeps pace with the dynamic demands of the global market economy.

Glocal as the winning formula:

An open innovation framework will be key to scaling and sustaining growth. Whether for trusted flow of data or a new tech policy, having a glocal mindset will count as we make in India, for India and the world.

Citizen centricity: Historically, countries that focus on development keeping their citizens at the centre are the ones to thrive. Especially for a country with such a strong